
BBC LEARNING ENGLISH

Real Easy English

Coffee



This is a transcript of a spoken conversation and is not a word-for-word script.

Georgie

Hi Neil. How are you?

Neil

I'm very well thank you, Georgie. Are you enjoying your coffee?

Georgie

I am, but it's got a bit cool now. I prefer my coffee hot, but... oh well! Are you enjoying yours?

Neil

I've finished mine.

Georgie

Oh, that's a shame.

Neil

It's a sad moment when I've finished my second coffee of the day, because that's it. I don't have more than two.

Georgie

So, we're talking about coffee in this episode, aren't we?

Neil

We are. But before we start, of course, everyone needs to know that there is a free worksheet on our website. That's at bbclearningenglish.com.

Georgie

Yes, they can also find a free transcript, can't they?

Neil

They can, yes, at the same address. So, Georgie, we're talking about coffee. How much coffee, or how many coffees if we're talking about cups of coffee – how many do you have a day?

Georgie

I usually have two, and I know that you do as well, because we drink them both in the office, don't we? We have one cup of coffee in the morning and one usually in the afternoon, when we need to regain some energy and alertness.

Neil

Yeah. And so, we all know because we make each other... At BBC Learning English, we make each other coffee, so we know how we **take our coffee**.

Georgie

Yes. How we **take our coffee** is how we like it – what we like to put in it. For example, sugar or milk. I know that you don't like milk in your coffee. You **take your coffee** black.

Neil

I do. I like black coffee and you **take your coffee** white and you used to have sugar, but you don't anymore.

Georgie

That's right. Occasionally when I'm at home I put some honey in my coffee to make it a bit sweeter.

Neil

Eurgh! Honey in coffee?

Georgie

Yes. Is that surprising?

Neil

I've never heard of that.

Georgie

Really?

Neil

Sugar, but not honey.

Georgie

But why would that be so bad?

Neil

Well, I don't know. It's just I've never heard of it.

Georgie

It's really good. I would recommend.

Neil

OK. So, Georgie, what happens if you don't have your coffee?

Georgie

Well, in the morning if I don't have coffee, I feel very grumpy and very tired. In the afternoon if I don't have a coffee, it's not terrible, but I would prefer to have my afternoon coffee. How about you?

Neil

Yeah, I need my coffee, especially in the morning, but I don't have my coffee first thing in the morning.

Georgie

Oh, interesting.

Neil

I have it, kind of, I don't know... work time – nine o' clock.

Georgie

Why is that?

Neil

I think it's too strong, too powerful. Or maybe just the way I drink it.

Georgie

What happens if you drink too much coffee?

Neil

Ooh, then it's difficult to sleep because of the **caffeine**. **Caffeine** is that chemical in coffee and tea that makes you feel awake and alert. But too much means you're too alert.

Georgie

I don't think that **caffeine** has a big effect on me. I don't think I have trouble sleeping if I drink too much coffee. It's strange. Yeah, because sometimes I'll have an espresso after dinner.

Neil

Really?

Georgie

Yeah. And I can still sleep.

Neil

That's crazy.

Georgie

Yeah. Lucky me.

Neil

Lucky you!

Georgie

Neil, have you ever tried to **cut down on** coffee?

Neil

Cut down on... You mean have less? No, I haven't tried to **cut down on** coffee, but I've tried to **cut down on caffeine**.

Georgie

OK.

Neil

So, I... for a while, I only drank **decaffeinated** coffee, or **decaf**, as we call it.

Georgie

OK. And how was that?

Neil

Well, I didn't miss **caffeine** at the time, I don't think. It lasted for a long time, but now I drink **caffeine**. I don't care.

Georgie

OK. Neil, it's time to recap the vocabulary we used in the conversation. We used the verb **take**. So, Neil, how do you **take your coffee**?

Neil

I **take my coffee** black, and I know you **take your coffee** white.

Georgie

Yes. We also heard **caffeine**, which is the chemical that is in coffee, which makes you feel more awake.

Neil

Yes, but you can also get **decaffeinated** coffee or tea – it means there's no **caffeine**. And we usually shorten that just to **decaf** – **decaf** coffee.

Georgie

Yes. We also heard the phrasal verb **cut down on**, which means you have less of something.

Neil

Yep. And you can also say **cut back on**. It means the same thing.

Georgie

OK. Well, that is the end of this conversation about coffee in Real Easy English.

Neil

Yes, and if people want to watch more episodes of Real Easy English, what should they do?

Georgie

They should go to our website, bbclearningenglish.com, where they can find a free worksheet to test what they've learned. Goodbye for now.

Neil

Goodbye!